

Reset Visual Assist Trial Period

Step by step guide

Visual Assist license check explained

Visual Assist uses Armadillo license protection. It relies on 3 checks:

- “fake” temp file in %TEMP% folder
- “fake” CLSID entry in HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT
- Another registry entry in HKCU\Software

You must take care of all 3 checks of the protection in order to reset the trial period.

Detect the name of the “fake” CLSID

- Use registry monitor application to track the registry I/O activity of Visual Studio Process (devenv.exe). I prefer [Process Monitor](#).
- Search for the first occurrence of “HKCU\Software\Whole Tomato” - this is where the VA add-on begins its registry I/O. From this point search the first registry access to HKCR entry and record its name and location for later use.

14:36:58.9593963 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegOpenKey	HKCU\Software\Licenses	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9593963 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegSetInfoKey	HKCU\Software\Licenses	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9594053 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegQueryValue	HKCU\Software\Licenses\{R7C0DB872A3F777C0}	NAME NOT FOUND
14:36:58.9594156 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegCloseKey	HKCU\Software\Licenses	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9595878 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegQueryKey	HKCU\Software\Classes	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9595989 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegQueryKey	HKCU\Software\Classes	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9596087 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegQueryKey	HKCU\Software\Classes	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9596227 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegOpenKey	HKCU\Software\Classes\Wow6432Node\CLSID\{20E5BD72-8EEA-C94C-3EDD-1EF1BC073962}	NAME NOT FOUND
14:36:58.9596465 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegOpenKey	HKCR\Wow6432Node\CLSID\{20E5BD72-8EEA-C94C-3EDD-1EF1BC073962}	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9596691 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegSetInfoKey	HKCR\Wow6432Node\CLSID\{20E5BD72-8EEA-C94C-3EDD-1EF1BC073962}	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9596819 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegQueryKey	HKCR\Wow6432Node\CLSID\{20E5BD72-8EEA-C94C-3EDD-1EF1BC073962}	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9596921 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegQueryKey	HKCR\Wow6432Node\CLSID\{20E5BD72-8EEA-C94C-3EDD-1EF1BC073962}	SUCCESS
14:36:58.9597110 q.	devenv.exe	1072	RegOpenKey	HKCU\Software\Classes\Wow6432Node\CLSID\{20E5BD72-8EEA-C94C-3EDD-1EF1BC073962}	NAME NOT FOUND

Uninstall Visual Assist and delete license information data entries

- Uninstall Visual Assist add-on from Visual Studio Extension Manager
 - 1st stage of protection – “fake” temporary file. Usually its enough to simply delete the contents of the %TEMP% folder
 - 2nd stage of protection – “fake” CLSID registry entry – delete the CLSID, belonging to VA, that you detected earlier
 - 3rd stage of protection – delete HKCU\Software\Licenses – it sounds very generic, but only VA uses this key
-
- Start Visual Studio and install Visual Assist from Extension Manager Online Gallery and enjoy new 30 day trial period.